

- b) The study of Basic Personality allows us to explore the deep-seated psychological motivations and conflicts that underlie cultural phenomena." Discuss in view of Abraham Kardiner's Idea of Culture Personality School. (15 marks)

The study of BASIC PERSONALITY is attributed to Ralph Linton, Abraham Kardiner, contributions from Conrad Du Bois's model personality.

Abraham Kardiner's Idea of Culture Personality:-

- ① He was inspired by Freudian theory that childhood trauma can help us gain adult's deep seated psychological motivations.
- ② In collaboration with Ralph Linton, he wrote "Psychological Frontiers of Culture (1954)".
- ③ This was in response to Ruth Benedict's "Configuration School".

Concept of Basic Personality:-

He defined it as "The fundamental traits of personality or behaviour that are found in people of that culture".

To expand, ① He said there is a basic



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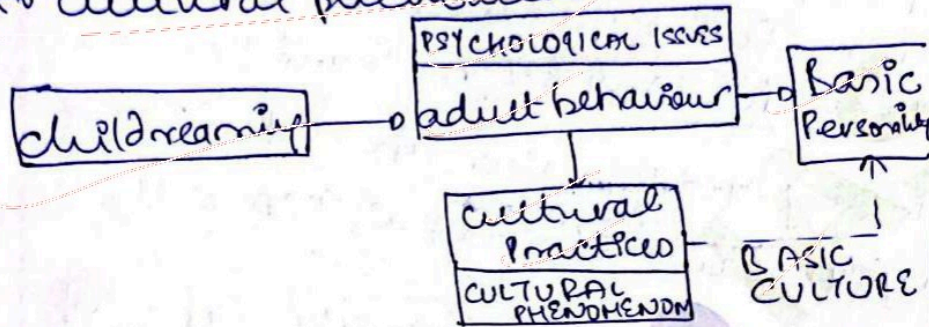
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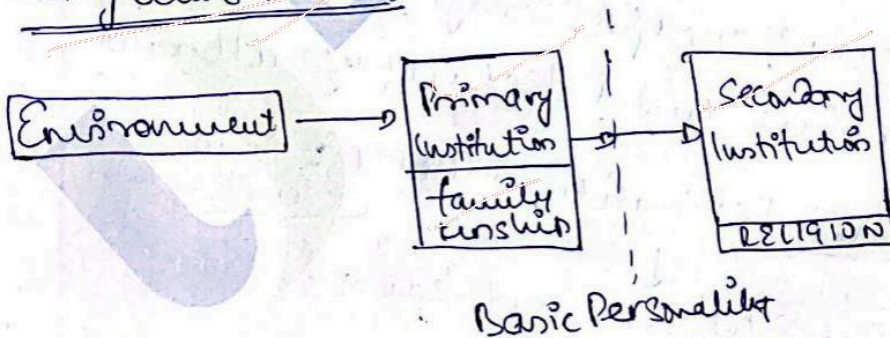


culture - one that is involved in child rearing and this leads to explore the psychological motivations that lead to cultural phenomenon.



### Personality Mediation:-

He said that environment affects "Primary Institutions" (that are involved in child rearing). This impacts the basic personality, this impacts 2° (secondary institution) that relieve anxiety.

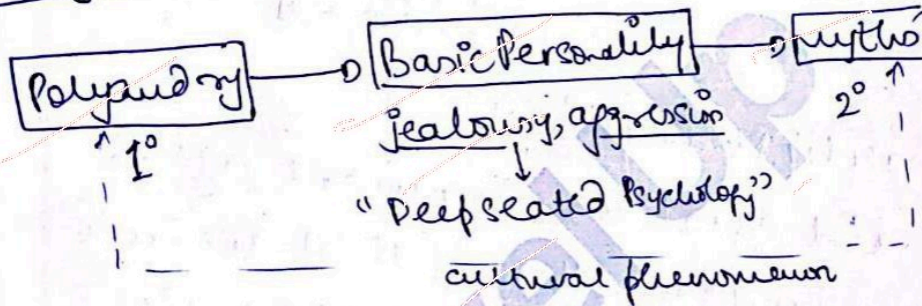


Now there is relation of basic personality, psychological motivations and cultural conflict.



## STORY of Marauding & Marquesas Tribes

The lack of nutrition results in people exposing child bearers to marauding tribes, this results in female infanticide. POLYANDRY rises and this causes jealousy and aggression in males. These myths have stories of WICKED WOMEN.



## STORY of Tanala and Bilsethu Tribes:-

Cardiner applied theory in CROSS cultural comparison of Tanala (horticulturalists) and Bilsethu (agriculturalists).

The Basic Personality of TANALA : calm (security of food)  
 ↓  
BILSETHU : anxious (fear of food insecurity)

Criticism :- It was thought that all people may not have the same "basic" personality. Cora Du Bois developed modal personality based on this.